Technische Hochschule Nürnberg

Fakultät Informatik

RaspberryPi CyberSec Lab: Development of a Penetration Testing Platform

Bachelorarbeit im Studiengang Elektro- und Informationstechnik

vorgelegt von

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Kurzdarstellung

Diese Arbeit befasst sich mit der Entwicklung einer Testplatform für Cyberangriffe mit dem Fokus auf Funkverbindungen. Im Rahmen den Projekts wurde auf Basis von RaspberryPi OS Software entwickelt, um Umgebungen zu schaffen, in denen verschiedene Cyberangriffe getestet werden können.

Abstract

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Chapter 1.

Introduction

"Dennoch geht man davon aus, dass Wirtschaftsspionage allein in Deutschland Schäden von von vielen Milliarden Euro jährlich verursacht." [Hell 23, page 3] "Eine funktionierende IT-Infrastruktur ist für ein Unternehmen unerlässlich, doch wird deren Bedeutung of unterschätzt. Wie verschiedene Untersuchungen zeigen, überlebt ein Unternehmen bei einem anhaltenden Totalausfall der IT sehr wahrscheinlich nur wenige Tage." [Hell 23, page 3]

1.1. This is an Important Section

It is possible to reference glossary entries as library as an example.

1.1.1. And an even more important subsection

Chapter 2.

Wifi Basics

2.1. WiFi History

In 1985 the american Federal Communications Commission ruled serveral bands in the 2.4 GHz radio band to be unlicensed, meaning everyone can broadcast radiosignals in these frequencies. At the beginning of the 90's, this lead to the development of different wireless communication protocols by multiple companies. To ensure interoperability between these protocols, the IEEE 802.11 standard was created and released, and WLAN was born. In 1999 the Wi-Fi Alliance (WFA) was founded to further improve compatibility, nowadays consisting of over 750 international companies. [Sank 21, page 1-3], [Wiki 25]

Since its inception over 25 years ago, Wi-Fi has gone through constant development, leading to six major generations of the technology. Improvments in speed, efficiency and security have lead to the technology becoming a "fundamental utility [...], that everyone [...] expects to be available everywhere" [Sank 21, page 1]. WiFi connects billions of devices, like computers, smartphones, game consoles or IoT devices to the internet, generating a value of around 4.9 trillion USD worldwide [Sank 21, page 1].

WiFi operates at the physical (PHY) and the medium access control (MAC) layer of the OSI model, sending ethernet frames over radio waves in the 2.4 and 5 Ghz frequency band. The Mac layer is responsible for seting rules on tranmission and reception of data, connection management and power management. Data sent on the MAC layer then gets converted to radio waveforms by the PHY layer, which is also responsible for converting received data back to the MAC protocol. [Sank 21, page 4-7]

2.2. MAC layer

2.2.1. Architecture

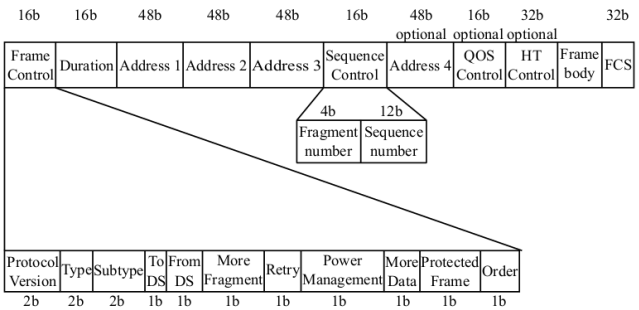
Commonly WiFi networks have access points (AP), which are connected to the internet via ethernet, and stations (STA), which are provided with internet access over WiFi by the

AP. WiFi has a MAC layer, which is designed to be flexible and can be configured in the following topologies:

- **BSS**: Basic Service Set
- **IBSS**: ad hoc / peer-to-peer / Independent BSS
- **WDS**: Wireless Distribution System
- **MBSS**: Mesh BSS

BSS describes the most common and basic configuration, where multiple STAs are connected to one AP, which has wired connection to the internet. IBSS networks dont have any APs, instead the STAs are connected directly to each other. WDS can be used, when the reach of an AP needs to be extended, but there is no wired connection available. A secondary AP can be installed which receives backhaul connection from another AP. Mesh Networks are complex BSS networks with multiple APs, which the STAs can hop between. This type of network can improve the signal coverage and resilience and is often used in companies or public institutions with many STAs. [Sank 21, page 8-9]

2.2.2. MAC Frames



When data is sent over the MAC layer, it gets divided into chunks, which are called MAC Frames. MAC Frames have three components: the header, the body and the frame check sequence. The header contains information about the source and destination, the sequence and serveral control functions. In a BSS network it has the following functions:

- **Frame Control** contains 16 Bits which serve different control functions

  protocol version describes which version of the MAC protocol this frame uses

  type describes the type of MAC frame is beeing used: there are data, management, control and acknowledgment frames

  subtype describes the subtype of the frame, e.g. association request or beacon frame

from/to ds indicates the direction of travel

more fragment indicates more following fragments

retry indicates that the current frame is a retransmission

power management gives information about the power state of the STA

more data indicates more frames are to be transmitted

protected frame indicates whether a frame is encrypted

order set to 1 if the order of processing is important

- **duration** indicates the time of the transmission, therefore how long the medium is occupied
- **adress 1** contains the receiver address (RA), which can be the MAC address of the destination STA or the BSSID of the AP, depending on the direction, the frame travels
- **adress 2** contains the transmitter adress (TA), which can be the BSSID or the source address.
- **adress 3** contains either the source or destination address
- **sequence control**

  fragment number ensures the correct processing sequence of the fragments

  sequence number number of the frame

The Frame body then contains the payload, meaning the actual information to be sent. Every type of MAC frame is configured a different way to suit their specific function. "While data frames are meant to carry data, management frames are used for connection management and control frames [...] for triggering specific actions. Control frames have a smaller MAC header and no payload data [...]. Management frames have a structured payload composed of some fixed length fields and one or more variable length fields called information elements (IEs)" [Sank 21, page 12]

After the frame body comes the frame control sequence (FCS), which ensures the integrity of the frame. The FCS is a cyclic redundancy check (CRC), which is number calculated from the frame header and body content. When the frame is compromised in traffic, the result of the CRC changes, therefore the error can be identified. [Geek 23] [Sank 21, page 10-12]

2.2.3. Medium Access

In LAN and WLAN networks all devices share the same medium, therefore only one device at a time can transmit information. Ethernet networks use full-duplex transceivers, meaning a device can transmit and receive data at the same time. This allows the transceiver to transmit and simlutaniously listen for collisions with other frames. Collision detection is quite effective, but can not be used in WiFi networks, because WiFi transceivers are only capable of half-duplex tranmission. WiFi instead uses a medium access control referred to as carrier sense multiple access collision avoidance (CSMA-CA).

When using this technique, the medium gets blocked during transmission and is freed by an acknowledgment frame, sent by the receiving device. All STAs start off in the random backoff state, where they listen for traffic. After the random backoff counter has expired and no traffic is present, the STA will start transmission. CSMA-CA can be described by the way "humans converse in a group, where every individual would first listen to check if someone else is talking, wait for the person talking to finish, and then start talking after a brief random pause" [Sank 21, page 12]. [Oriy 17, chapter Attacking Integrity Controls] [Sank 21, page 12-17]

2.2.4. Connection Establishment and Termination

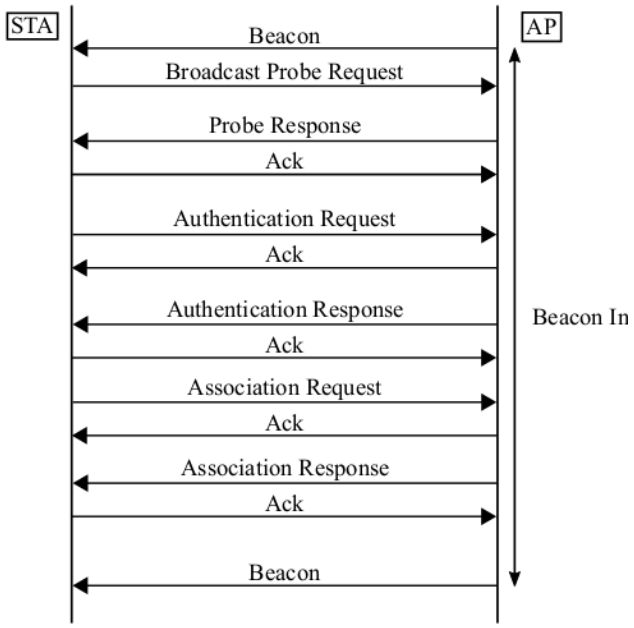
Before a connection can be established, the STA first needs to discover the AP it wants to connect to. This can be done by either active or passive scanning of all available channels.

During active scanning, the STA transmitts a management frames, called probe requests on all channels to all SSIDs in the vicinity. The APs answer with a probe respose frame, which contains the AP's SSID, BSSID and its capabilities.

Passive scanning works by the STA listening for beacon frames. Beacon frames are periodically sent out by APs and also contain information on SSID, BSSID and capability. [Sank 21, page 18]

Once the desired network is discovered the STA decides which AP to connect to, based on parameters, like the receive signal strength indicator (RSSI) or the APs capacity, performance and security. The STA then sends an authentication request, which the AP gives an authentication response to. If the credentials of the STA are valid and the authentication is successful, the STA proceeds to send an association request. The association response, sent by the AP, then indicates, if the connection was established successfully.

To terminate a connection, either the STA or the AP can send a disassociation or deauthentication frame, "containing a reason code that specifies the reason for termination" [Sank 21, page 20]. [Sank 21, page 19]



2.3. PHY layer

The WiFi PHY layer is based on radio frequency (RF), therefore WiFi transceivers contain a transmitter and receiver circuit, as well as an antenna. When sending data, MAC frames are encoded and modulated onto a RF waveform which is then transmitted via the antenna. On arrival of data, the receiver circuit decodes the data, extracts the MAC frame, and provides it to the MAC layer. The first generations of WiFi used to transmit in the 2.4 Ghz band, but due to it beeing used by many other devices, such as cordless phones, computer peripherals, bluetooth devices or microwave ovens, WiFi 4 started using the 5 Ghz band, in order to improve connectivity. [Sank 21, page 5,34,35] With every generation of WiFi, the PHY layer components are modified to improve performance and efficiency, but due to the PHY layer not beeing majorly significant for cybersecurity, it will not be described further in this thesis.

2.4. Security

Through the widespread adoption of WiFi technology, for example in smart homes, infrastructure, public spaces, industry and goverments, the security of WiFi networks plays an ever increasing role. Therefore principles of cybersecurity need to be applied, in order to guarantee that networks are safe, reliable and performant. Cybersecurity aims to protect devices and data by achieving the CIA triad, which is an acronym for Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability [Oriy 17, chapter Attacking Integrity Controls] . Because of its wireless nature, "[i]t is difficult to confine the data-carrying radio waves to be within the physical security

perimeter of [an] organizsation" [Sank 21, page 103], so anyone in the vicinity of a WiFi network could just intercept and manipulate network traffic. To ensure integrity and confidentiality, WiFi two main security mechanisms, which are encryption and authentication. [Sank 21, page 103]

2.4.1. Encryption

Encryption is a cryptographic [1] method, which takes the readable data, called plaintext, and makes it unreadable for anyone besides the recipient. The encrypted text is called ciphertext and can be made readable again, by decrypting it. To en- and decrypt a message, the sender and recipient have knowledge of a secret, often a passphrase, which controls en-/decryption and is called key. [Watj 18, page 1]

The first "secure" WiFi standard, called wired equivalent privacy (WEP) uses a shared key, with a RC4 stream cipher algorithm for message encryption and a 32-Bit CRC as a integrity check (IC). Due to serveral vulnerabilities of WEP, including the RC4 algorithm, a lack of authentication and no key management, the second standard, wireless protected access (WPA), was developed. WPA still used RC4 for compatibility reasons, but the encryption is based on a pairwise master key, which is generated for each STA after it has authenticated successfully.

Table 2.1.: Evolution of Wi-Fi Security [Sank 21, page 123]

	WEP	WPA	WPA2	WPA3
Certification start	-	2003	2004	2018
Mandatory since	-	2006	2006	2019
Information element	None	WPA IE	RSN IE	RSN IE
Encryption	RC4	TKIP	TKIP, AES-CCMP	AES-CCMP, AES-GCMP
Authentication	None	PSK, 802.1X	PSK, 802.1X	SAE, 802.1X
Open Wi-Fi security	None	None	None	OWE

[1] cryptography = science of secretive writing

Chapter 3.

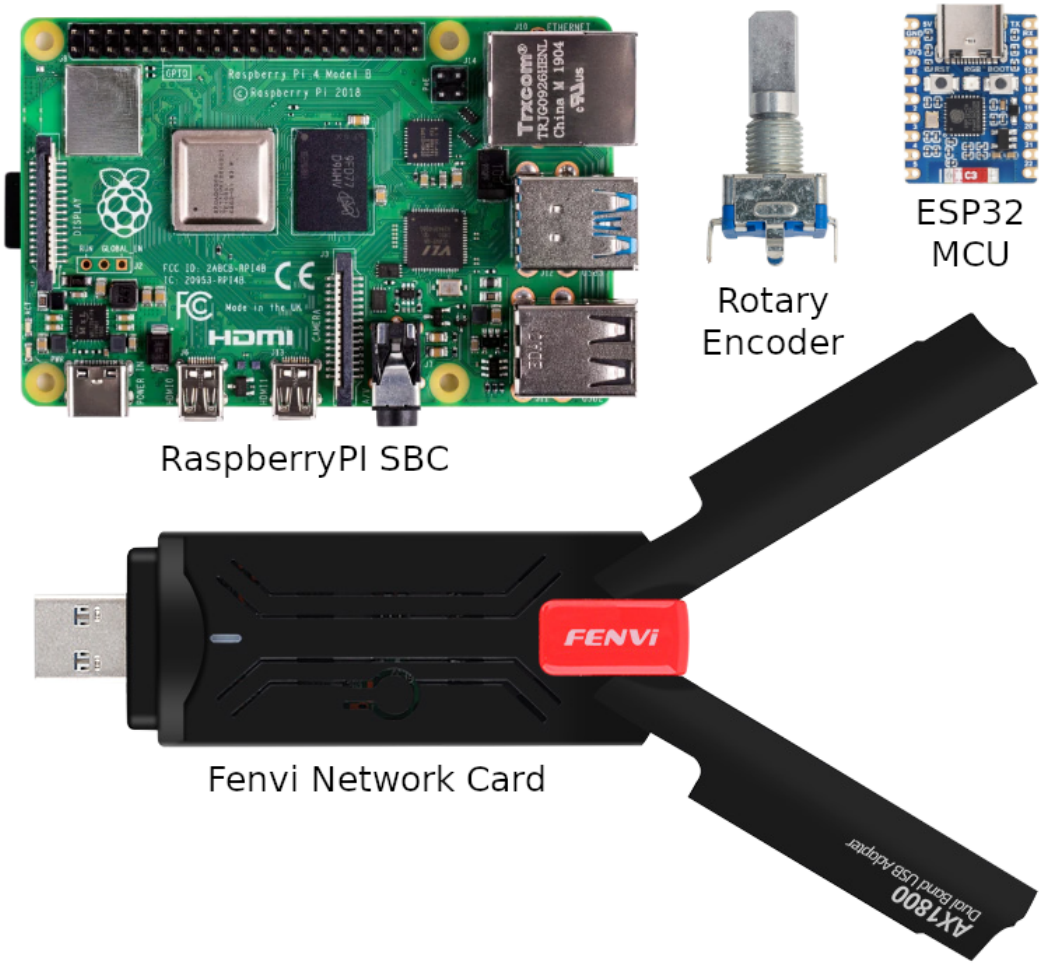
Architecture

"IoT-Geräte sind häufig über ein Web-Interface zugänglich. Daher habe viele der Probleme bie IoT-Geräten mit unsichere Webanwendungen zu tun." [Hell 23, page 174]

3.1. Hardware

The Project is realized using a RaspberryPI as the central device, connected to which are an external network card, an ESP32 microcontroller, a display and a rotary encoder for user input.

As the main computer the RaspberryPI 4B with 8GB of RAM was chosen due to its ease of use, linux based operating system and widely available documentation.



3.2. Software

The software of the project is mostly modular, it consists of a central program, which runs the user interface and then executes various shell scripts, with which the functions are implemented. When executing the setup script, the main program, which is written in C++, gets compiled and the executable gets called by the start.sh script. The program then displays the user interface, which is a simple interface, printed into the console. Each page of the UI is a "Menu" object, each menu has a title, options of the type "MenuOptions", a variable to track the currently selected option, a method to add options to a menu and methods for navigation, input capture and displaying. MenuOption objects have a name, as well as an action of the std::function type, which can be executed by calling the execute() method. In the main of the program, the constructors for menues and the addOption() methods are beeing used, to create the different menues and their submenues. The program starts by call-

ing the navigate() function of the main menu, which then displays all available submenues and menu options. All submenues work in the same way as the main menu, getting their respective navigate() called upon selection. During navigation the UI peridiodically prints the available options, using unicode to highlight the currently selected option as well as to give contrast to the title of the menu.

For input the device uses a rotary encoder with a pushbutton, turning the encoder moves the selection up or down in the menues, the pushbutton executes the selected option. The encoder is connected to the RaspberryPIs GPIO interface and the input signals are read and processed by the encoder program. The start.sh script starts both programs and pipes the stdout of encoder into the stdin of main. When an action of the encoder is detected, the according command gets sent to main, the commands beeing the unicodes for the up/down arrows and the enter key on a keyboard. For example, the User turns the the encoder one click clockwise, therefore main receives one downwards arrow symbol and the selections moves to the next option below. Because no special commands are utilized for navigation, the program can be easily tested on any computer by navigating with the keyboard.

When an action is executed, main calls the according shell script with the system() function. The wifiActivate.sh script is used to open wifi hotspots, where the user can choose the type of Wifi standard beeing used. It receives an input command and then establishes a WEP, WPA, WPA2 or WPA3 network.

Listing 3.1: extract of wifiActivate.sh

```
#!/bin/bash

scriptdir="$(dirname␣"$0")"

read -n 4 connection

if [ "$connection" == "WEP" ]; then
   exists=$(nmcli connection show | sed -n '/Wifi-WEP␣/p')
   if [ -z "$exists" ]; then
      sudo nmcli device wifi hotspot con-name "Wifi-WEP" ssid "WEPtest" password
```

With the wifiReset.sh script, the user can deactivate the active network. Once a network has been cracked, the wifiNewPassword.sh script can be used to give a new random password to the selected network. The script the pulls a random password out of a password list, which contains popular passwords that have been filtered to work with the specification of each network standard. To display the current status of the network, meaning its security standard, SSID and password, the wifiStatus.sh script is used.

```
#include <string.h>
int x = 1;
```

```
if(x == 1){

    printf("x is 1.");
}
```

Listing 3.2: This is an example of inline listing

You can also include listings from a file directly:

```
x = 1
if x == 1:
    # indented four spaces
    print("x is 1.")
```

Listing 3.3: This is an example of included listing

Chapter 4.

Worklog

4.1. Abc

Chapter 5.

Wifi Attacks

One of the earliest and most commonly used forms of attack used to target access control is a technique known as war driving. This technique, simply put, is to use a wireless enabled device along with specialized software used to detect or probe wireless networks that have come with in range of the wireless device. What makes war driving so popular and so effective is the fact that many computer users, both personal and business, have been deploying 802.11 wireless access points for years with little regard for security. The deployment of a wireless network that allows the user to roam has taken precedence over taking measures to secure their access points and devices against potential attack. In response to this deployment of wireless networks that are misconfigured or insecure, we have a category of attackers that engage in this practice known as war driving. Those who engage in this activity will build custom rigs built out of a combination of hardware and software, with the intent of cruising public venues to find both wireless access points and devices in some cases. These individuals may just be interested in locating and targeting a specific network for their own ends or, in some cases, they may even share this information to an online database or website where any visitor can search for these access points.

[Oriy 17]

5.1. Abc

Chapter 6.

Penetration Testing

6.1. Abc

Chapter 7.

Educational Use

7.1. abc

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Outlook

Chapter 9.

Summary

Appendix A.

Supplemental Information

Anleitung zum Raspi-CyberSec-Lab

Jonas Schmitt

6. März 2025

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Glossary

library A suite of reusable code inside of a programming language for software development. i, 1

shell Terminal of a Linux/Unix system for entering commands. i